

# Cura

*A field study in care.*

A slow-fashion pop-up built on a single word, care. For what we make, what we choose, and the world it all comes from.

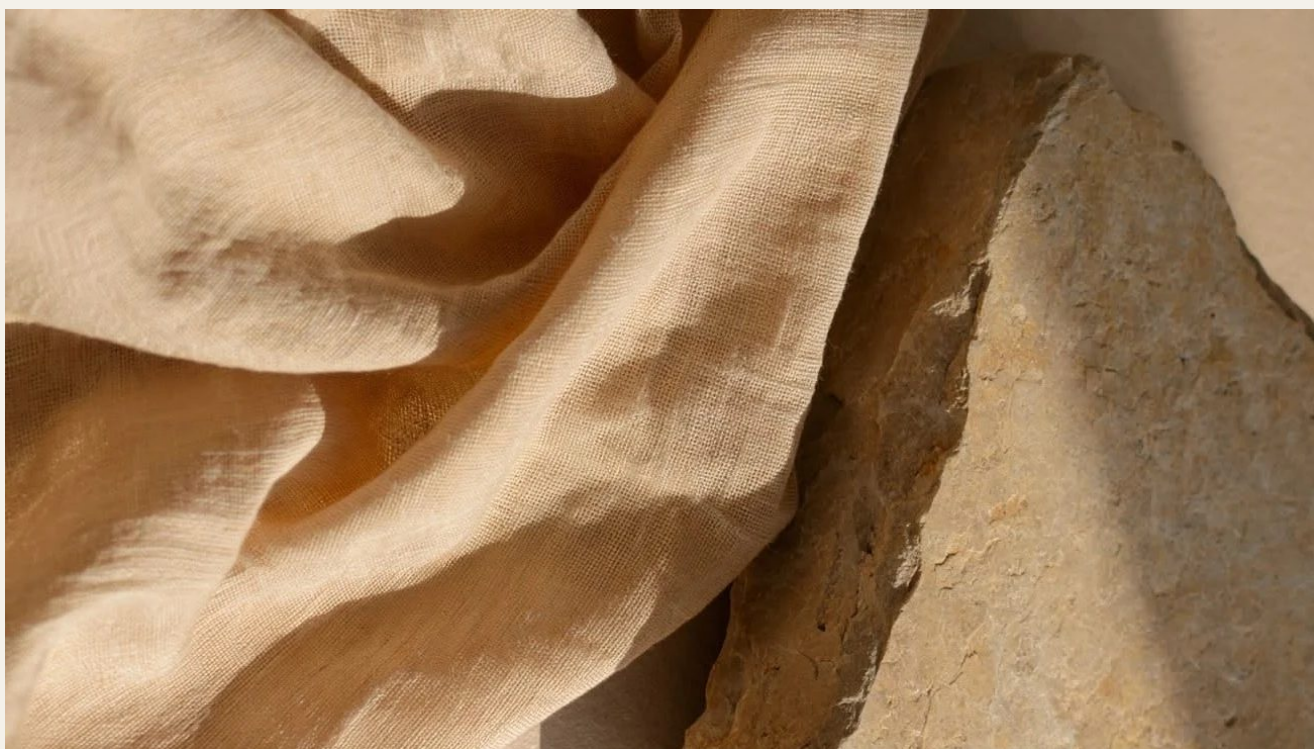


Plate 01, linen, light and stone [ [enlarge](#) ]

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## THE LIVE INTERACTIVE EXHIBIT

**[liv-sanchez-interiors.netlify.app](https://liv-sanchez-interiors.netlify.app)**

Open the link above to walk the exhibit, click any image to enlarge it, and play the films. Every image in this document also links to its full size online.

Liv Sanchez Interiors · Small Commercial Project · SDS 0902

# Introducing Cura

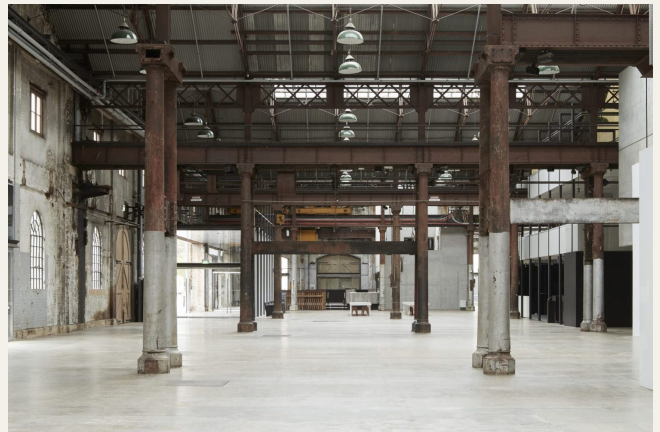
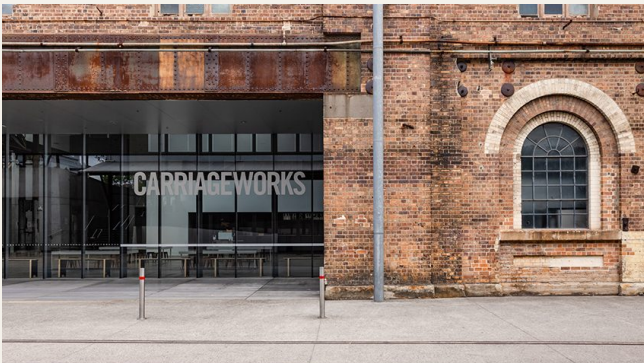
Cura is a slow-fashion and lifestyle pop-up, and everything about it comes back to one word, **care**. Care for the materials, for the craft behind them, and for the environment that yields them. It sits inside Carriageworks in Eveleigh as part of Sydney Festival, with a simple intent: to make people slow down for a moment, actually touch and notice natural materials, and leave with something they have made themselves.

The experience is built in two interlocking parts, a curated retail edit and a hands-on personalisation studio, so buying and making sit side by side. You arrive a browser and leave a maker, carrying a piece you have a real connection to.

## The site and the idea

The brief asked for a temporary pop-up at Carriageworks: a commercial zone and an interactive zone, sustainability front and centre, and at least three of the senses engaged.

Carriageworks is a 19th-century brick rail workshop, all exposed brick, repeating iron-framed gabled bays and raw industrial volume. That rawness pushed the whole project towards a grounded, earthy material direction. The Festival crowd is culturally switched-on, inner-city and values-driven, so slow fashion felt like exactly the right fit.



The heritage brick and steel exterior, and the iron columns and gabled trusses within [\[ enlarge \]](#)

### Two artists shaped the direction

Janet Laurence gave the **why**: glass, botanicals and veils, nature as care. Kengo Kuma gave the **how**: layered bamboo and soft, filtered light. From there the name **Cura**, Latin for care, simply landed. The design response is an organic, curved 80 m<sup>2</sup> plan with two interlocking zones, two ways in and out, four senses engaged, and a full zero-landfill plan for when the pop-up comes down.



Janet Laurence, the why · Kengo Kuma, the how [\[ enlarge \]](#)

The customer is into slow fashion and conscious living: largely female, 25 to 45, inner-city Sydney, who values a tactile experience and genuinely cares about where things come from.



## Concept board



Textures of care: raw linen, water, glazed clay, leaf vein, pressed botanicals, rammed earth and filtered light [\[ enlarge \]](#)

## The Mood and Offering

One curved path, browse to make. The retail edit is the outer ring; the personalisation studio sits at the heart.

### Zone 01, the retail edit, outer ring

Garments, textiles and a few lifestyle pieces. Two curved garment rails, a round travertine-look display bench, spotted-gum offcut shelves, cream limewash plaster walls, sheer linen drapes over timber battens, backlit botanical panels, and a change room behind block-out curtains.

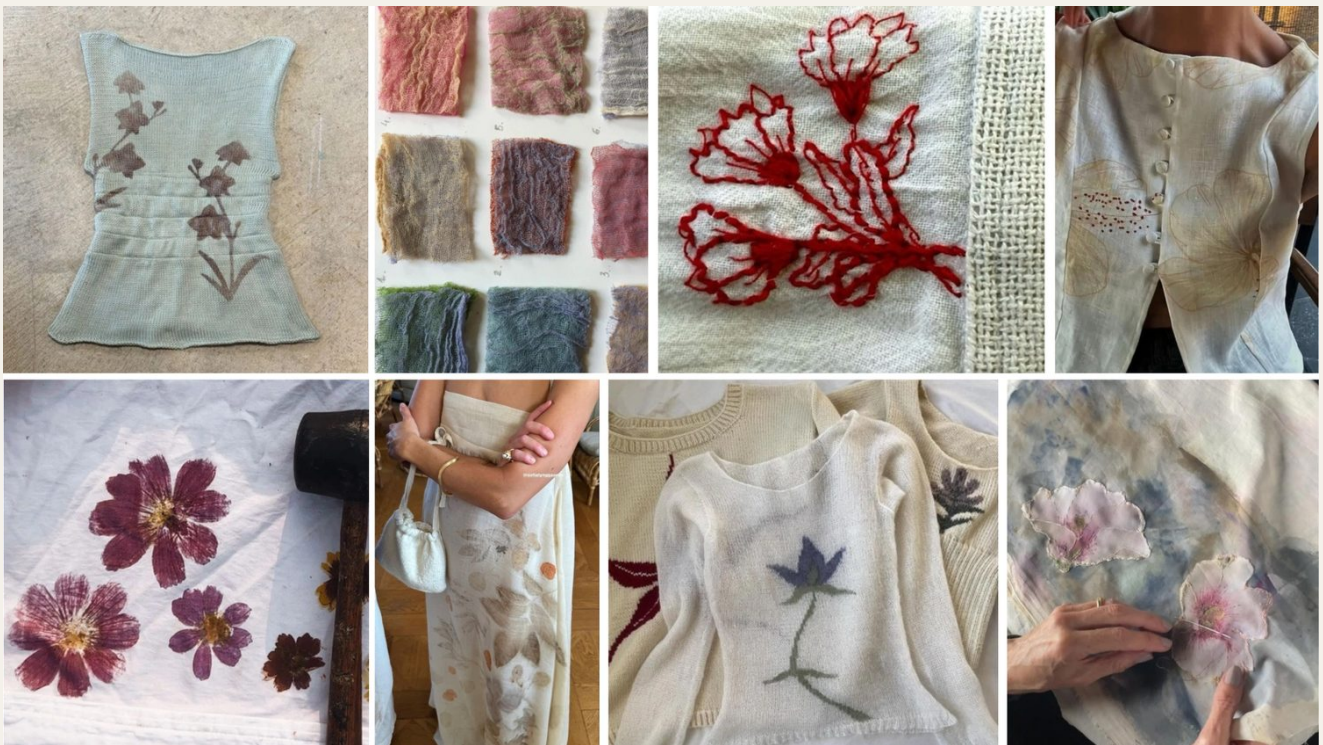
### Zone 02, the personalisation studio, inner

Where it gets hands-on. Visitors customise a raw-linen piece with botanical printing and natural dyes, then take it home. A cashier counter, a personalisation bar with a rammed-earth base and spotted-gum slab top, raw timber stools, glazed botanical displays along both walls, and a dried botanical canopy overhead on jute twine.





Mood board: the feel of the space, earthen interiors, curved counters, bamboo and linen [\[ enlarge \]](#)



The offering: naturally dyed and botanically printed linen, the piece you take home [\[ enlarge \]](#)

## Four senses engaged

### Sight

Warm rammed-earth tones and sandy ochre; light through the bamboo screens and linen drapes; the dried botanical canopy overhead; backlit botanical panels and glazed botanical displays.

### Touch

Rammed-earth walls, the spotted-gum bench top, raw-linen garments and the travertine-look plinth, surfaces you want to run a hand over.

### Smell

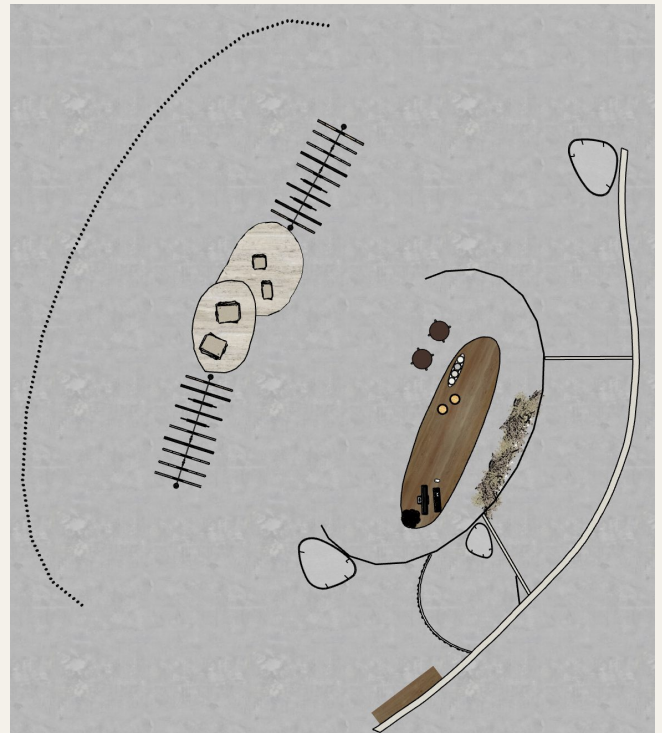
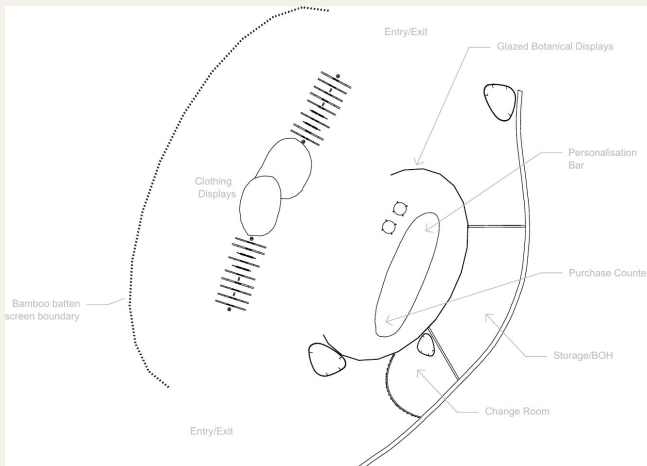
Raw earth and clay, the natural dyes working during the workshop, dried botanicals overhead, and timber.

### Sound

Quiet, nature-layered background music carried softly across both zones.

## The plan

An organic, curved plan across 80 m<sup>2</sup>, two interlocking zones with a soft boundary between them and entry from either side. You arrive in Zone 1, move through the retail edit, then drift inward to Zone 2. The existing polished-concrete floor stays exactly as it is.



Labelled plan, and the rendered plan: retail edit as the outer ring, studio at the heart [\[ enlarge \]](#)



# Elevations and perspectives

The space, rendered and in section.

## Perspectives



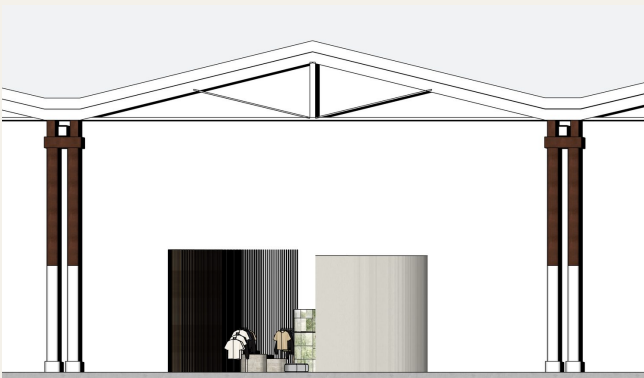
Inside the retail edit: garment rails, the glazed botanical cylinder and the bamboo screens [\[ enlarge \]](#)



The glazed botanical cylinder · the personalisation counter with botanicals overhead [\[ enlarge \]](#)



## Elevations



The whole insertion under the gabled trusses · the bamboo screen beside the curved limewash volume [\[ enlarge \]](#)



Read through the heritage brick arches - close on the glazed botanical window and the batten screen [\[ enlarge \]](#)

## Sample board



Material swatches sized to how much each is used in the space [\[ enlarge \]](#)





1. Rockcote lime wash Wall finish
2. Warwick Inari Sheer curtain
3. Warwick Inari blockout curtain
4. Spotted Gum 180mm Timber
5. Spotted Gum 180mm Timber
6. Spotted Gum 180mm Timber
7. Rammed Earth Counter Base
8. Hepburn Hardware Rail antique bronze
9. Adairs Nora Travertine Table set
10. Huntley & Co Banjo Bar Stool Oak

The same board, each swatch numbered and named, keyed to the FF and E schedule [\[ enlarge \]](#)

Two atmosphere films (the retail front and the personalisation bar) and the full walkthrough play in the live exhibit at the link on the cover.

# Schedule of finishes, furniture and fixtures

The full FF and E board: fifteen line items, each with its supplier, cost, a product photo and sustainability notes. The three finishes carried through to full sustainability research are marked FEATURED.

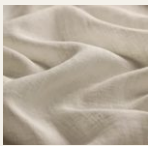
## FINISHES and FIXED ELEMENTS



### 1.0 RC-LW15 Rockcote Lime Wash Mineral lime wash. Tint: 'Warm Limestone', natural yellow-ochre oxide at light dosage (warm neutral). [FEATURED]

Walls, retail space · Rockcote · ~\$85 / 15L pail

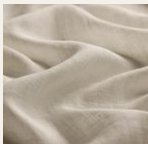
Natural mineral product. Zero VOCs. Breathable, regulates moisture in wall. Biodegradable. No synthetic binders. Recyclable packaging (cardboard pail). End of life: plaster returned to earth.



### 2.0 FIN04ANGO Warwick Inari Sheer, Angora

Curtains in front of timber battens, retail zone · Warwick Fabrics · POA (trade)

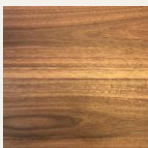
70% linen / 30% wool. Both natural fibres, linen is one of the lowest water-use crops; wool is renewable and biodegradable. FR-rated without chemical treatment. Donated to textile recycler at end of festival.



### 3.0 WAR-BO Warwick Blockout curtain fabric Blockout range

Curtains, change rooms · Warwick Fabrics · POA (trade)

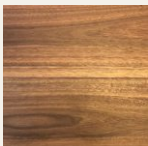
Blockout linen-look. Same natural fibre blend as Inari sheer. Donated post-festival. Avoids synthetic blackout coatings where possible, confirm with Warwick at order stage.



### 4.0 ET-SG Spotted Gum 180mm Timber [FEATURED]

Benchtop over rammed earth counter · Safety & Civil Supply Co. · \$78.57 / m<sup>2</sup> ex GST

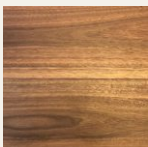
Engineered timber uses less old-growth timber than solid hardwood. Spotted gum is a fast-growing Australian native. FSC certification recommended, confirm at order. Offcuts repurposed (items 5 & 6). Can be salvaged and resold post-festival.



### 5.0 ET-SG Spotted Gum 180mm Timber (offcuts) Same product as above, fabricated from offcuts

Custom shelves outside change room · Safety & Civil Supply Co. · From offcuts, nil/minimal extra

Offcuts, zero additional material waste. Circular use of resource. No new timber required.



### 6.0 ET-SG Spotted Gum 180mm Timber Same product as above, run as large battens

Large battens behind sheer curtains · Safety & Civil Supply Co. · \$78.57 / m<sup>2</sup> ex GST

Engineered timber uses less old-growth timber than solid hardwood. Spotted gum is a fast-growing Australian native. FSC certification recommended, confirm at order. Offcuts repurposed (items 5 & 6). Can be salvaged and resold post-festival.

## FURNITURE and FIXTURES



### 7.0 REC-CB01 Rammed Earth Counter Base [FEATURED]

Counter base (supports spotted gum benchtop) · Reference: Rammteck (Riyadh) · POA (custom)

Rammed earth is one of the most sustainable building materials available. Raw subsoil only, no cement required for temporary installation. 100% returned to earth post-festival. Zero embodied carbon disposal.





### 8.0 HH-URB-AB Hepburn Hardware Utility Rail End Brackets Solid brass, antique bronze

Curtain rail + garment/clothing racks (coathanger rail) · Hepburn Hardware · \$124.00 per bracket

Solid brass, highly durable, recyclable at end of life. Antique bronze finish is a patina process, not a coating, so no toxic stripping required. Long lifespan reduces replacement frequency.



### 9.0 56014RVN0073086 Adairs Nora Travertine Table set

Display tables between garment racks · Adairs · \$499.99 / set of 2

Faux travertine (MDF + laminate). Lower sustainability credentials than natural stone but lighter and reusable. Can be resold or donated post-festival via Adairs takeback or marketplace.



### 10.0 HUN-BANJO-OAK Huntley & Co Banjo Bar Stool Oak (x3, HIRE)

Personalisation bar seating · Huntley + Co · POA (hire), qty 3

Hire item, no ownership, no disposal. Lowest embodied carbon option for furniture. Oak is a renewable hardwood. Returned to Huntley + Co after festival.



### BW-01 Dried Flower / Pressed Botanical Wall Custom feature wall

Feature wall · Grandiflora · POA (custom)

Dried botanical specimens sourced locally (eucalyptus, grasses, seed pods). Compostable at end of festival. Jute twine is biodegradable. Zero synthetic materials.

## LIGHTING (all 2700K warm white LED, daytime operation)

### DOM-FINO-27 LED Strip Behind Botanical Panels, 2700K Domus Lighting FINO

Decorative, backlit panels · Domus Lighting · POA

LED strip, energy efficient, long lifespan (50,000+ hrs). Reused post-festival. No mercury (unlike fluorescent). Low heat output.

### BG-D900-27 Concealed LED in Ceiling Batten, 2700K Brightgreen

Decorative, ceiling · Brightgreen · POA

LED strip, energy efficient, long lifespan (50,000+ hrs). Reused post-festival. No mercury (unlike fluorescent). Low heat output.

### INL-UW-27 Narrow Wash Uplighters, 2700K Inlite

Accent, timber battens · Inlite · POA

LED strip, energy efficient, long lifespan (50,000+ hrs). Reused post-festival. No mercury (unlike fluorescent). Low heat output.

### DOM-LS-27 Recessed LED Strip Under Counter, 2700K Domus Lighting

Accent, counter lip · Domus Lighting · POA

LED strip, energy efficient, long lifespan (50,000+ hrs). Reused post-festival. No mercury (unlike fluorescent). Low heat output.

Costs indicative. POA means price on application. The existing concrete floor is retained, so no new material and no cost.

## Three materials, followed cradle to grave

The three finishes carrying the strongest sustainability story, researched from what they actually are through to where they end up.

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### 01 WALLS, RETAIL SPACE

#### Rockcote Lime Wash

|                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| WHAT IT IS            | Natural mineral limewash on the retail walls, tinted 'Warm Limestone' with a light dose of yellow-ochre oxide for a warm neutral. Solvent-free and low-VOC.                                                                                     |
| WHY IT IS SUSTAINABLE | A natural mineral product with very low embodied energy: zero VOCs and no synthetic binders. It breathes, so it regulates moisture in the wall, and it runs on a carbon cycle, reabsorbing CO2 from the air as it cures. <b>Source: BioLime</b> |
| HOW IT IS MADE        | Naturally occurring limestone is burnt to a lime putty, tinted with natural mineral oxides and mixed with water. No synthetic additives. On the wall it slowly turns back toward limestone as it hardens.                                       |
| LIFESPAN              | A breathable finish with self-healing micro-cracks that develops character over time. Recoating is just another thin lime layer, not a strip-back, which suits a pop-up.                                                                        |
| PACKAGING             | Delivered in recyclable cardboard pails.                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| END OF LIFE           | Fully biodegradable. The plaster is returned to earth after the festival.                                                                                                                                                                       |

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### 02 PERSONALISATION STUDIO

#### Rammed Earth Counter Base

|                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| WHAT IT IS            | A custom rammed earth counter base in ochre and terracotta tones, supporting the spotted gum benchtop in the personalisation studio.                                                                                                                                                                      |
| WHY IT IS SUSTAINABLE | One of the most sustainable building materials available: raw subsoil only, with no cement needed for a temporary installation, so embodied carbon at disposal is effectively zero. Earth construction can cut environmental impact by around 50% versus conventional walls. <b>Source: ScienceDirect</b> |
| HOW IT IS MADE        | Raw earth and subsoil are compacted in layers within formwork under pressure. No firing, no chemical treatment, no synthetic additives.                                                                                                                                                                   |
| LIFESPAN              | Extremely durable with real thermal mass, and it improves with age. Best for a solid mass element like the counter base.                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| PACKAGING             | Effectively none. Mixed and built up on site, then transported to the pop-up.                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| END OF LIFE           | 100% returned to earth after the festival. Zero waste, zero landfill.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

## Spotted Gum Engineered Timber

|                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| WHAT IT IS            | Spotted gum 180mm engineered timber as the benchtop over the rammed earth counter, with offcuts repurposed as custom shelves and large battens. One product, three uses.                                                                                                           |
| WHY IT IS SUSTAINABLE | Engineered timber uses significantly less old-growth timber than solid hardwood, and spotted gum is a fast-growing Australian native, so transport is short and the timber stores carbon. FSC certification recommended, confirm at order stage.<br><b>Source: Wood and Beyond</b> |
| HOW IT IS MADE        | Timber is harvested and milled into engineered boards with a click or tongue-and-groove system, which maximises yield and minimises waste.                                                                                                                                         |
| LIFESPAN              | Commercial grade, durable and long-lasting, and the surface can be sanded back and refinished. Offcuts are fully used across the three applications, so there is zero waste from this material. <b>Source: Globalcarpets</b>                                                       |
| PACKAGING             | Delivered in standard 1800 to 2100mm lengths with minimal packaging.                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| END OF LIFE           | Salvaged and resold after the festival. The offcuts are already fully repurposed within the project.                                                                                                                                                                               |



# When the pop-up comes down

Every part of the build has somewhere to go after three weeks. Nothing is made just to be binned.

|                                 |                                           |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Lime wash plaster               | Returned to earth, fully biodegradable    |
| Rammed earth counter base       | 100% returned to earth, zero landfill     |
| Spotted gum benchtop            | Salvaged and resold                       |
| Spotted gum shelves and battens | Salvaged and resold, from offcuts         |
| Warwick sheer curtains          | Donated to a textile recycler             |
| Warwick blackout curtains       | Donated to a textile recycler             |
| Brass rail brackets             | Recycled, solid brass, no toxic stripping |
| Travertine-look display tables  | Resold or donated via Adairs              |
| Oak bar stools                  | Returned to Huntley and Co, hire items    |
| Dried botanical feature wall    | Composted, jute twine biodegradable       |
| All LED lighting                | Reused after the festival                 |

*Target: zero landfill.*

# Self-evaluation

## 01

## What was successful about the design?

The concept of Cura was the strongest part of my design. The idea of care for materials, craft, and the environment gave every decision a clear direction. The organic curved floor plan worked well in creating a natural journey through the space, drawing visitors from the retail zone inward to the personalisation studio. The material palette felt cohesive and grounded, with limewash plaster, rammed earth, spotted gum, and dried botanicals all reinforcing the concept. The sustainability approach was also a highlight, with every material having a documented post-event pathway and a zero landfill target.

## 02

## What changes would better communicate the concept?

If I were to make changes, I would spend more time rendering the perspectives to better communicate the atmosphere of the space, particularly the warmth of the materials and lighting. A more developed sample board with physical swatches would also have strengthened the presentation of the material palette.

## 03

## What were the challenges in translating the concept into a space?

The main challenge was translating an abstract concept into a functional commercial space. Balancing the earthy, organic aesthetic with practical requirements, like fitting the cashier counter, personalisation bar, sewing station and storage into the inner zone, required a lot of plan refinement. Getting the curved boundary between the two zones to feel intentional rather than arbitrary was also difficult to communicate in 2D drawings.

## 04

## How would you improve your concept-development process next time?

Next time I would start my material research earlier in the process, so that material decisions could inform the concept rather than follow it. I would also give myself more time between the initial concept development and the spatial planning stage, to ensure the two were more deeply connected from the beginning.

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The complete interactive exhibit, with the walkthrough and atmosphere films, lives at [liv-sanchez-interiors.netlify.app](https://liv-sanchez-interiors.netlify.app).

For the FF and E in full detail, open the source spreadsheet (every product photo, supplier, cost and sustainability note): [download the FF and E board \(xlsx\)](#).